

Last time we introduced the question of what we should believe. We began by

considering this rule of belief:



No Proof $\rightarrow$ No Belief

If you can't give a good
argument for P, don't
believe P.

all, which seems very implausible.

But we saw that this led to the result that you should not believe anything at

At the very least, it seems, we should believe things that we can be certain of:

This is a version of a view known as foundationalism.

It can be summed up with the following negative rule of belief:



No Falsification → No Belief

your senses don't tell you that P

argument for P , you should not

If you can't be certain that P and

and you can't give a good

De l'île
à l'île.

Foundationalism is the view that the only basic beliefs you should have are

the ones you can be certain of and ones which you sense tell you are true.

Certainty $\rightarrow$ Belief

If you can rule out any situation which would make P false, you should believe P .

Experience → Belief

If your sense experience tells you that P, and you have no reason to think that your sense experience is misleading, you should believe P.

Good Argument $\rightarrow$ Belief

If there is a valid argument for P and you should believe each of that argument's premises, you should believe P.

figuring out what the world is like are our sense and our ability to see that

entain claimst be true.

This is an appealing idea. The core thought is that only two routes to

considered.

We can compare

this to some of the

other negative rules



of belief - we have